

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ Q J 9 5 3
 ♦ Q 9 7 2
 ♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ K Q 9 6 5 3

♥ 6 2

♦ J 5

♣ K 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 7 2

♥ A 8

♦ A K 6 4

♣ A J 3

♠ 10 8 4
 ♥ K 10 7 4
 ♦ 10 8 3
 ♣ Q 8 2

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by South

Then play to dummy's ♠K. West shows out and you must temporarily stop drawing trumps.

For the elimination play to work you must strip ♦s from both hands. So play both the ♦ A K, then ruff a ♦ with the ♠Q. Pull trumps with your ♠ A J, then ruff the last ♦ in dummy.

The work is done. Just play a ♥. Whichever defender wins must either play a ♣ into your split tenaces, or play a red card and give you a ruff/sluff.

This is the complete Deal.

If you knew who held the ♣Q then you wouldn't have to learn Elimination plays.

These are the hands after the trumps have been pulled and ♦s eliminated from both North and South.

You now play the ♥, eliminating that suit from both hands. Whichever defender wins the trick must either play another ♥ and give you a ruff/sluff, or play a ♣ and give you a free finesse. Either way you will make the slam.

With a maximum 2NT opener, 4 of partner's ♠s and a doubleton you jump to 4♠, the Super-Accept.

Partner wastes no time bidding the slam.

South plays 6♠. West leads the ♥Q. West finds their best lead, exposing your ♥ loser. With a different lead you could have led toward dummy's ♦J, but not now.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

A very simple Plan would be for you to pull trumps and then guess who holds the ♣Q. Simple, but putting your slam on a 50% chance isn't very satisfying.

How about an elimination play instead? Win the ♥A.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 4
 ♥ Q 10 9
 ♦ K J 5
 ♣ Q 10 7 2

♠ J 2

♥ 6 5 4

♦ A 8 7 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 7 5 3

♥ K 8 7

♦ Q 10

♣ J 8 4

♠ A K Q

♥ A J 3 2

♦ 9 4 2

♣ A K 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT

Pass
 All Pass

3NT by South

Your best bet is going to be the ♦ suit, but dummy isn't exactly loaded with entries. How will you manage it?

When entries are really scarce the best approach is ducking. Win the ♣K and play a low ♦ from both hands. A defender will win this and probably continue with a ♣.

Stick to the plan. Win the ♣A and again play small ♦s from both hands, relaxing when both defenders follow suit to the second ♦.

They can now cash their 2 ♣s, and you had to give them 2 ♦s. But that's the only tricks they will get. Dummy's 3 ♦s are good and you still have a ♦ in your hand to get there.

When dummy has a long suit with no outside entries, always consider using a duck to make up for the lack of entries.

In this case it was a double-duck.

Partner has 20 or 21 points, balanced, and you have 6. You bid 3NT, hoping partner has ♦ K Q x.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♣2 and East plays the ♣J.

Question 1: Do you hold up?

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 7

The lead of the ♣2 tells you that West has only a 4-card suit, so there is no need to hold up. In fact if you did hold up East might play an unwelcome ♥ back.